



While on Tour

In addition to reading Chapter 4 on Tour Managers, here are a few extra tips for self-management.

if you don't have a tour manager, your regular manager can be the one managing the tour from the office. If you don't have a manager, a band mate should be in charge of making sure everything runs smoothly while out on the road. Here is a short checklist of things to remember each and every night:

1. Settle the box office – collect money after the show.
2. Count the house – depending on your history with the venue or promoter, you may want to take tally's and/or count how many people come in the door (if you're getting a cut of the sales).
3. Confirm the hotel bookings.
4. Confirm the flights (if you're flying).
5. Daily itinerary – keep it visible
 - a. Ensure it is digitally accessible.
 - b. Print it out. And print it out twice in case it gets ruined.
 - c. Sometimes Internet service cuts out and computers die so you need paper copies, which can also get destroyed in a messy tour van.
6. Email lists: Keep region specific email lists so that you can target your emails when touring in a certain location the next time around.
 - a. Extra tip: use international/national email lists for non-location specific emails that include information such as a new video release

Tour Finances

From the artists' perspective, if you want to come out on top, it's more efficient to cut expenses instead of trying to earn more. This is because the more the artist earns, the more they payout to the managers and agents. If artists cut expenses, that's more money in their pockets. If you're a manager reading this, you can help your artist out by telling them this. Here are a few other ways to cut costs:

- Keep smaller stage sets.
- Spend less on hotels and food. Try to suck it up, while still staying healthy and well rested.
- Less backtracking. This goes back to a good tour routing – mentioned above.
- Draft a budget well before you go – keep the expenses fixed – and try to spend less than projected.